

pod is not operational for an extended period, these posts may not be delivered.

You will see the public posts related to hashtags from your own pod. In addition, your pod can be configured to receive public posts from a relay server. The scope can be for all the posts or just for a list of hashtags. The pod may also opt to send public posts to a relay server. The default options are false.

Alternatives

The primary open source alternative to Diaspora is Friendica. It is written using the LAMP stack and has built-in support for the Diaspora protocol. Hence, users on Friendica and Diaspora can share messages with each other. The site <https://the-federation.info/> gives information about the servers running the Diaspora protocol. Another interesting project supporting the Diaspora protocol is Hubzilla.

Is there any hope for the alternatives? Probably yes,

as the 'List of social networking websites' on Wikipedia illustrates. Other social networks may be small but can still serve a significant social need.

If pods are hosted by common interest groups but are still part of a federated environment, it would make it easy for people to join and find others whom they wish to share their interests with. Since advertising revenue is not at stake, the numbers do not need to be absurdly huge in order to be successful.

Diaspora and Facebook were created by college students! So, colleges seem to be the ideal places to set up federated servers and change the world. 

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com>, <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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suggestion or a complaint?

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